

Process to Apply for a Passport

Fresh, Re-issue, Tatkaal, Diplomatic/Official, Identity Certificate and applying from abroad

Source

Hub page: <https://www.passportindia.gov.in/psp/ApplyPassport>

Abroad portal: <https://mportal.passportindia.gov.in/mission/embassy>

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About this document: a plain-language summary written from the pages above. It is not a verbatim copy and not an official publication. The site's content belongs to the Ministry of External Affairs, Government of India; always confirm details on the official site before acting.

The Passport Seva portal groups "Apply for Passport" into five routes. This guide covers each one in turn, in the order the site lists them:

1. Fresh or re-issue of an Ordinary passport
2. Tatkaal (urgent) passport
3. Diplomatic or Official passport
4. Identity Certificate
5. Applying from abroad through an Indian Embassy, High Commission or Consulate

Site notice on the retrieval date: passport application fees were revised with effect from 1 July 2026. Check the current amount in the Fee Calculator (<https://www.passportindia.gov.in/psp/FeeCalculator>) before you pay.

1. Fresh or re-issue of an Ordinary passport

Source page: <https://www.passportindia.gov.in/psp/applyFor>

Fresh or re-issue: which one applies to you

The site's re-issue page explains that the category depends on whether you have ever held a passport of the same type. Ordinary passports are deep blue, Diplomatic passports maroon and Official passports white.

- **Fresh:** you have never held a passport of the type you are applying for. Someone who holds only a Diplomatic or Official passport still applies as Fresh for an Ordinary passport.
- **Re-issue:** you hold, or once held, a passport of that type and need another one, for example because details changed, it expired or is close to expiry, the pages are used up, or it was damaged or lost.

The six steps

1. **Register and log in.** Use [Register](#) in the portal menu, fill in your details and sign up. Confirm your e-mail address, then log in with the login ID and password you created.
 - Passwords expire and have to be reset every three months.
2. **Open the application.** On your dashboard go to *Services* (on the overview page or in the left menu) and choose the card *Apply for Fresh Passport/Re-issue of Passport*.
3. **Choose your Regional Passport Office (RPO) first.** Select the RPO for the place where you live now. It decides which Passport Seva Kendras are offered when you book.
 - You may apply at any PSK or RPO in India, whichever suits you.
 - To re-issue through a different RPO from the one that issued your current passport, you need a new login ID. Register again (the same e-mail address can be reused), select *Passport Office* and choose the PSK or RPO you want.

4. **Fill in the form.** It has nine parts: Passport Type, Applicant Details, Family Details, Address Details, Emergency Contact, Previous Passport, Other Details, Passport Preview and Details Verification.
 - You can save a draft at any point and continue later.
 - Submitting generates a unique Application Reference Number (ARN).
 - Check every entry before submitting. A submitted application cannot be edited.
5. **Pay the fee and book an appointment.** Open the submitted application and choose *View > Pay and Schedule Appointment*. Paying the fee in advance is compulsory for an appointment at any Passport Seva Kendra.
 - Choose online payment, then the appointment quota (Normal or Tatkaal). The Tatkaal quota is offered only for Tatkaal applications.
 - Pick the Passport Seva Kendra (PSK) or Post Office Passport Seva Kendra (POPSK) you prefer. The portal shows its next available date.
 - Check the details and select *Pay and Book Appointment*. You are sent to the payment gateway and, after paying, back to the portal, where the appointment confirmation appears.
 - If you have already paid or already hold an appointment, use the *Schedule/Reschedule Appointment* link instead.
 - This page says an appointment can be rescheduled three times, or once for Tatkaal.
6. **Attend the appointment.** You receive an SMS on your registered mobile number with the appointment details. Take all required documents to the PSK on the day.

Points the site asks you to note

- Service is given at the discretion of the officer in charge of the Passport Seva Kendra or the Passport Officer.
- For a child under 4 years, bring a recent passport-size photograph, 4.5 x 3.5 cm, on a white background.
- If you do not visit the Passport Seva Kendra within 90 days of submitting the online form, the form has to be submitted again.

Extra detail from the site's separate re-issue page

Source page: <https://www.passportindia.gov.in/psp/ApplyReissue>

- Online payment can be made by credit or debit card (MasterCard, Visa, RuPay), internet banking (State Bank of India, its associate banks and other banks) or UPI.
- You can print an application receipt showing the ARN and appointment number, but a printout is no longer required. The appointment SMS is accepted as proof.
- Visit the PSK or RPO where the appointment is booked with your original documents.
- Only emergency or medical cases and pre-approved categories may come without an appointment.

Documents, fees and standard forms

- Documents required: use the Document Advisor on the home page, which has separate lists for fresh and re-issue applications.
- Fee: Fee Calculator, <https://www.passportindia.gov.in/psp/FeeCalculator>
- Annexures and affidavits linked from the page:
 - Annexure A, Identity Certificate: <https://www.passportindia.gov.in/AppOnlineProject/pdf/AnnexureA.pdf>
 - Annexure C, parent or guardian declaration for a minor where one parent has not consented: <https://www.passportindia.gov.in/AppOnlineProject/pdf/AnnexureC.pdf>
 - Annexure D, parent or guardian declaration for a minor: <https://www.passportindia.gov.in/AppOnlineProject/pdf/AnnexureD.pdf>

- Annexure F, specimen affidavit for a lost or damaged passport:
<https://www.passportindia.gov.in/AppOnlineProject/pdf/AnnexureF.pdf>
- Annexure G, No Objection Certificate:
<https://www.passportindia.gov.in/AppOnlineProject/pdf/AnnexureG.pdf>
- Annexure H, Prior Intimation letter: <https://www.passportindia.gov.in/AppOnlineProject/pdf/AnnexureH.pdf>
- Annexure I, declaration confirming the particulars given about a minor:
<https://www.passportindia.gov.in/AppOnlineProject/pdf/AnnexureI.pdf>
- Appendix 12, special cases of minors:
https://www.passportindia.gov.in/AppOnlineProject/pdf/Appendix_12.pdf
- Annexure J, joint declaration in place of a marriage certificate:
<https://www.passportindia.gov.in/AppOnlineProject/pdf/AnnexureJ.pdf>

2. Tatkaal passport

Source page: <https://www.passportindia.gov.in/psp/TatkaalPassports>

Tatkaal is the urgent route. The online application follows the same steps as section 1, with the Tatkaal quota chosen when booking. The Tatkaal page itself deals with the extra documents, who is excluded, the undertaking and the appointment rules.

Extra documents

These come on top of the usual proofs of address, date of birth and non-ECR status, where those apply.

- Applicants over 18: any **three** documents from the list below.
 - Applicants under 18: any **two** documents from items 1 to 6 of the list.
1. Aadhaar: PVC Aadhaar card, the complete original Aadhaar letter, or an e-Aadhaar with UIDAI's verified digital signature mark. Small cut-outs or smart cards printed by anyone other than UIDAI are not accepted.
 2. PAN card
 3. Student photo identity card from a recognised educational institution
 4. Birth certificate issued under the Registration of Births and Deaths Act, 1969
 5. Ration card, latest or updated
 6. Last passport issued (re-issue cases only)
 7. Electors Photo Identity Card (EPIC)
 8. Driving licence, valid and within the jurisdiction of the State where you apply
 9. Bank, Kisan or Post Office passbook, with your attested photo and the latest transaction updated
 10. Scheduled Caste, Scheduled Tribe or Other Backward Class certificate
 11. Arms licence issued under the Arms Act, 1959
 12. Pension documents, such as an ex-serviceman's pension book, a pension payment order for a retired government employee, an ex-serviceman's widow or dependent certificate, or an old age pension order
 13. Service photo identity card from the Central or a State Government, a public sector undertaking, a local body or a public limited company

Who cannot use Tatkaal

- Any change of name
- Present address outside the jurisdiction of the RPO
- A minor's application with Annexure C, for example where the parents are divorced or separated

- Applicants repatriated from abroad at Government cost
- Applicants deported to India, or who travelled on an Emergency Certificate
- Persons of Naga origin, including minors, and persons of Naga origin living outside Nagaland
- Persons of Jammu and Kashmir origin, including minors
- Applicants covered by section 6(2)(e) or 6(2)(f), which relate to criminal court cases
- Applicants with an adverse police report, on a watch list, who habitually lose passports, or who earlier travelled on forged or fake passports
- Fresh applications from:
 - citizens by registration or naturalisation (citizenship granted by the Ministry of Home Affairs)
 - children adopted by Indian or foreign parents
 - a child born out of wedlock with a single parent
 - children born through surrogacy
 - minors with a single parent
- Re-issue applications involving:
 - a lost or stolen passport
 - re-issue of a short validity passport
 - a passport damaged beyond recognition
 - a change in sex, appearance or signature
 - a change or correction of date or place of birth
 - a change of father's, mother's or spouse's name

Undertaking and appointments

- Every Tatkaal applicant fills in the "Undertaking for Tatkaal Scheme": [Hindi](#) or [English](#).
- A Tatkaal appointment can be rescheduled only **once**. This has applied since 1 April 2023.
- The page links to a list of the times at which Tatkaal appointments open at each Passport Office, and to the Tatkaal FAQs (<https://www.passportindia.gov.in/psp/FaqTatkaalPassports>).
- The site's Getting Started page adds that Tatkaal applicants pay the full applicable fee online, and that Tatkaal is not currently offered at Post Office Passport Seva Kendras.

3. Diplomatic or Official passport

Source page: <https://www.passportindia.gov.in/psp/ApplyDiplomatic>

These passports are for people who hold diplomatic status or whom the Government of India sends abroad on official duty.

1. **Register** on the Passport Seva online portal.
2. **Log in** with the login ID you created.
3. **Choose Apply for Diplomatic/Official Passport.**
4. **Fill in** the form and submit it.
5. **Pay the fee and book an appointment.** Open the submitted application and choose *View > Pay and Schedule Appointment*. Paying the fee in advance is compulsory for an appointment at any Passport Seva Kendra.
 - Choose online payment, then the appointment quota (Normal or Tatkaal). The Tatkaal quota is offered only for Tatkaal applications.
 - Pick the Passport Seva Kendra (PSK) or Post Office Passport Seva Kendra (POPSK) you prefer. The portal shows its next available date.

- Check the details and select *Pay and Book Appointment*. You are sent to the payment gateway and, after paying, back to the portal, where the appointment confirmation appears.
 - If you have already paid or already hold an appointment, use the *Schedule/Reschedule Appointment* link instead.
 - This page says an appointment can be rescheduled three times, or once for Tatkaal.
6. **Submit in person.** Take a printed copy of the completed online form and your original documents to the Consular, Passport and Visa (CPV) Division, Patiala House, New Delhi, or to the Passport Office for your present address. The instruction page of the printed form has further detail.
- Photographs (from the site's FAQ): bring two colour photographs, 4.5 x 3.5 cm, on a white background, fixed to the printed form. The first goes on page 1 with no signature or stamp. The second goes on page 3 and is stamped across with the office stamp and signed by the Head of Office.
 - Documents: the Document Advisor on the home page has a list for Diplomatic and Official passports.

4. Identity Certificate

Source page: <https://www.passportindia.gov.in/psp/ApplyIdentity>

1. **Register** on the Passport Seva online portal.
2. **Log in** with the login ID you created.
3. **Choose** *Apply for Identity Certificate*.
4. **Fill in** the form and submit it.
5. **Pay the fee and book an appointment.** Open the submitted application and choose *View > Pay and Schedule Appointment*. Paying the fee in advance is compulsory for an appointment at any Passport Seva Kendra.
 - Choose online payment, then the appointment quota (Normal or Tatkaal). The Tatkaal quota is offered only for Tatkaal applications.
 - Pick the Passport Seva Kendra (PSK) or Post Office Passport Seva Kendra (POPSK) you prefer. The portal shows its next available date.
 - Check the details and select *Pay and Book Appointment*. You are sent to the payment gateway and, after paying, back to the portal, where the appointment confirmation appears.
 - If you have already paid or already hold an appointment, use the *Schedule/Reschedule Appointment* link instead.
 - This page says an appointment can be rescheduled three times, or once for Tatkaal.
6. **Submit in person.** Take the printed application form, self-attested photocopies and the original documents (the page gives a passport and proof of foreign nationality as examples) to the Passport Office for your present address.

Background from the site's Certificate of Identity FAQ

Source page: <https://www.passportindia.gov.in/psp/FaqIdentityCertificate>

- A Certificate of Identity is normally issued to Tibetan refugees living in India, by the Regional Passport Office in Delhi on the recommendation of the Bureau of His Holiness the Dalai Lama, New Delhi.
- Stateless people living in India can also apply, at the Passport Office for the area where they live.
- Issue is subject to clearance by the Ministry of External Affairs (PSP Division). The certificate is generally valid for 10 years.
- It cannot normally be applied for outside India. Holders return to India before it expires and apply at RPO Delhi. Tibetan refugees on full-time regular courses at recognised foreign universities are the exception and can apply for re-issue at the Indian Mission or Post in that country.
- Fee: Fee Calculator, <https://www.passportindia.gov.in/psp/FeeCalculator>

Do not confuse this with the "Identity Certificate" in Annexure A. That is a letter from an employer, which government, public sector and statutory body employees attach to an ordinary passport application.

5. Applying from abroad

Source pages: <https://mportal.passportindia.gov.in/mission/embassy> and <https://mportal.passportindia.gov.in/mission/BeforeYouApply>

The "Apply Passport Abroad" option leaves the main portal and opens a separate site, Passport Seva at Indian Embassies and Consulates. Start by choosing the portal for the region you live in (Asia Pacific, Europe, Africa and Middle East, or Americas), or pick your region and country from the lists.

1. **Register** using the Register link.
2. **Log in** with your registered login ID and password.
3. **Start a new application** from the applicant home page. One link covers Ordinary Passport, Emergency Certificate, Police Clearance Certificate, Surrender of Indian Passport, Diplomatic Passport, Official Passport and Identity Certificate.
4. **Print** the form after it has been submitted successfully.
5. **Visit** the relevant application processing centre, Embassy or Consulate with the supporting documents.
6. **Find where to submit** through the "Embassy/Consulate Connect" link, which leads to the website of the Indian Embassy, Consulate or outsourced service provider for your country.

Photographs: the abroad portal states that ICAO-compliant photographs have been required for passport applications since 1 September 2025. Guidelines: https://mportal.passportindia.gov.in/pdf/Guidelines_for_ICAO_Compliant_Photos_for_Passport_Applications.pdf

Where the site is inconsistent

Two details differ between pages of the official site. Confirm them on the portal when you book.

- **Rescheduling:** the application pages say three times (once for Tatkaal). The Getting Started page says rescheduling or cancellation is allowed up to two times within a year of the first appointment date.
- **Internet banking:** the re-issue page lists State Bank of India, associate banks and other banks. The Getting Started page says State Bank of India and associate banks only.

Useful links

- Apply for Passport hub: <https://www.passportindia.gov.in/psp/ApplyPassport>
- Register: <https://services1.passportindia.gov.in/forms/registration>
- Login: <https://services1.passportindia.gov.in/forms/PreLogin>
- Fee Calculator: <https://www.passportindia.gov.in/psp/FeeCalculator>
- Quick Guides (official PDF walkthroughs): <https://www.passportindia.gov.in/psp/QuickGuides>
- Acceptable proofs of address: <https://www.passportindia.gov.in/psp/ListDocuments>
- Acceptable proofs of date of birth: <https://www.passportindia.gov.in/psp/ListDOB>
- National Call Centre: 1800-258-1800